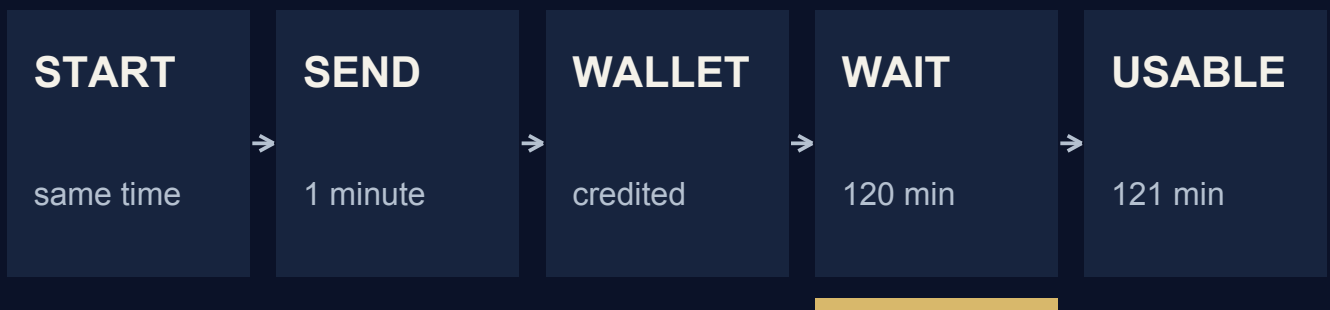


A faster transfer, a longer wait

One minute to the wallet. Two more hours before the money can be used.

AN INVENTED CASH-NEEDED JOURNEY



Where should the stopwatch stop?

Hypothetical sequential timings. Same intended amount; fees and other delivery differences excluded. No programme performance claim.

A component can win its speed test while the service loses.

Draw the step after the transfer

The UNHCR Ukraine pilot description gives a historical reason to include a cash endpoint.

AID SENT AS USDC

Route described by UNHCR on 15 December 2022.

VIBRANT WALLET

Recipient receives the digital balance on a smartphone.

MONEYGRAM

A route to cash for recipients who choose to convert.

Historical architecture, not evidence of current availability or waiting times. Digital spending can have a different endpoint.

A wallet credit and usable cash are separate events.

Two routes. Two different winners.

Minutes from the same start. Remaining wait begins only after transfer completion.

ROUTE	TRANSFER + WAIT	USABLE AT
A	1 + 120	121 min
B	30 + 0	30 min

Invented values, not data or forecasts. Same intended amount. No overlap between intervals; fees and other delivery differences excluded.

Route A wins the transfer by 29 minutes, then loses delivery by 91.

Which improvement changes the day?

Start with A: 1 minute transferring, then 120 minutes waiting. Total: 121 minutes.

HALVE THE TRANSFER

120.5 min

0.5 minute to transfer.

120 minutes still waiting.

Total saving: 30 seconds.

SHORTEN THE WAIT

21 min

Keep the 1-minute transfer.

Reduce remaining wait to 20.

Total saving: 100 minutes.

Separate hypothetical interventions. Arithmetic identifies a question; it does not prove feasibility, cost or safety.

Investigate the long wait before treating network speed as the answer.

Look beyond the success message

Possible constraints to investigate for a person who needs cash.

01

Opening hours

Can the person reach an open withdrawal outlet?

02

Available cash

Can the outlet supply the required amount?

03

Travel and access

What remains between the person and that outlet?

04

Digital use

If direct payment works, cash withdrawal may be unnecessary.

Questions to investigate, not observed programme failures.

The required endpoint depends on how the person will use the aid.

Keep two timestamps

Transfer complete. Intended amount usable. Define both before comparing routes.

A NARROW SPEED TEST

How fast did the transfer finish?

When could the person use the promised money?

The September 2026 announcement supports new payment work. Matched delivery results still need to answer this question.

Design proposal / No field outcome measured

Retain people who never reach the endpoint, with the observation deadline.

A real route. An invented race.

Primary announcements anchor the context. The timing examples are authored arithmetic.

S1 **Circle Foundation: UNDP and WFP support**

2026-09-25 / checked 27 Sep 2026

S2 **UNHCR: Ukraine payment pilot**

2022-12-15 / checked 27 Sep 2026

S3 **When Aid Becomes Spendable**

2026-09-27 / checked 27 Sep 2026

Read the full comparison method in the source Special. Public sources describe programmes; none supplied the invented timing values.

Do not read a thought experiment as an evaluation of an aid programme.